

Pay Slip

The news of Barack Obama's paypacket has raised eyebrows but there are many annual salaries that provoke the same reaction—for very different reasons...

Barack Obama

The charismatic 44th US President-elect will get \$4,00,000 (Rs 2 crore) per year.

Pratibha Patil

The President of India is paid Rs 18 lakh annually and also occupies the most exclusive real estate in India.

Manmohan Singh

Our prime minister's salary is Rs 8.34 lakh per annum—but the perks aren't bad.

Anil Ambani

The paycheque of chairman of Reliance-Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group is more than his brother's at Rs 48.01 crore.

Mukesh Ambani

Reliance Industries Ltd's chairman gives himself Rs 44 crore per year, 22 times more than the US President.

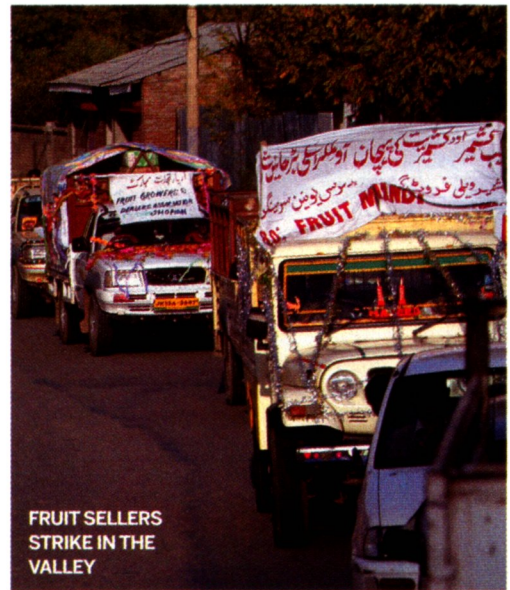
Larry Ellison

IT major Oracle's CEO makes \$193 million (Rs 965 crore) a year.

Illustrations by SAURABH SINGH

Srinagar | Fruitless Business

The absence of telecom and banking facilities is hitting the recently-started cross-border trade in Jammu & Kashmir. Fruit growers and traders in the Valley have decided to stop sending their consignments to Muzaffarabad in PoK. "We don't know what happened to the 7,000 fruit boxes we sent to Muzaffarabad. They were worth Rs 35 lakh," says Haji Farooq Ahmed Malik, president, Kashmir Valley Fruit Buyer's Association. The cross-LoC trade began on October 21 on the Srinagar-Muzaffarabad and Poonch-Rawalkote routes after 60 years. *by Alijazz Hussain*



B.K.RAMESH



Mysore | Headless Loss

Being headless may make the 92-year-old Mysore University lose out on a lot of money. It has been identified as Institution of Excellence by the UGC's National Assessment and Accreditation Council, making it eligible for a grant of Rs 100 crore to upgrade its facilities. The governor, however, has rejected three names of proposed vice-chancellors, forcing an MLC to go to court. The recent appointment of an acting vice-chancellor doesn't make the varsity eligible for the grant. *by Stephen David*

7

per cent growth is Manmohan Singh's forecast for the Indian economy in 2009.

Chandigarh | New Tune

The Shiromani Akali Dal has announced singer Hans Raj Hans as its candidate from Jalandhar parliamentary constituency. Hans' only political experience is as a singer drafted to draw and entertain crowds at the Akalis' political rallies.

by Ramesh Vinayak



BANDEEP SINGH